

Dear Human Interest hiring team,

Your mission is straightforward and respectable (plumbing thto close the small-business retirement gap), and the recent momentum I saw from looking up your company (the UBS partner, Forbes Fintech 50) tells me the product side is moving fast. That's the kind of engineering culture I'm eager to be in'

I've spent ten years building and owning production systems end to end, most recently as Lead Data Engineer at a 200-person insurer, where I rebuilt the enterprise reporting platform from scratch, cutting storage 50% and processing time 60%, while replacing opaque vendor logic with documented, tested internal systems. Outside of enterprise work, I ship full-stack apps solo: a Node/Express/TypeScript API with JWT auth and Zod validation behind a React front end, and a FastAPI/Postgres service.

The AI-agent piece of this role is where I think I stand out. I championed agentic coding tools at my company, ran the evaluation, and authored the security framework (least-privilege SQL logins, managed settings, MCP servers across environments) that cleared Claude Code for prod and cutting story delivery time in half. Directing AI agents as architect and reviewer rather than typing every line myself is already my daily bread and butter.

I also lead a small team now: hiring, onboarding, code review, mentoring. I don't have a startup or fintech background, but I've spent a decade in a regulated, audit-heavy industry building the reliable, observable systems. I'd happily bring that experience to the Human Interest team.

All the best,
Sander VanWilligen